TERBINAFINE

Hepatotoxic (oral)
Taste disturbance

CHEMICAL NAME (E)-N,6,6-trimethyl-N-(naphthalen-1-ylmethyl)hept-2-en-4-yn-1-amine (hydrochloride)
CLASS Allylamine antifungal
TRADE NAMES Lamisil · Terbisil · Daskil

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Onychomycosis (dermatophyte nail infection); oral treatment of choice.
- Tinea capitis, corporis, cruris, pedis (oral or topical).
- Ringworm not responding to topical therapy.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** once daily with or without food.
- **Topical** cream/gel/spray 1–2 times daily.

DOSAGES

- **Adult:** 250 mg once daily.
- Fingernails 6 weeks; toenails 12 weeks; tinea corporis/cruris 2–4 weeks; tinea pedis 2–6 weeks.
- **Children (tinea capitis):** 20–40 kg 125 mg; >40 kg 250 mg once daily for 4 weeks (no data <2 yr).
- Avoid if CrCl <50 (oral).

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Peak:** 2 h. Bioavailability ~40% (first-pass).
- Highly lipophilic — accumulates in skin, nails, hair.
- Metabolised in liver; inhibits CYP2D6. Excreted in urine. **t½:** 36 h (terminal ~16 days).

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Inhibits fungal **squalene epoxidase** → ↓ ergosterol and toxic squalene build-up → fungicidal against dermatophytes.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- GI upset, nausea, diarrhoea.
- Taste disturbance or loss.
- Headache, rash.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Hepatotoxicity (rare liver failure).
- Severe skin reactions (SJS/TEN), lupus exacerbation.
- Neutropenia, thrombocytopenia.
- Depression; prolonged taste loss.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Chronic or active liver disease (oral).
- Hypersensitivity.
- **Caution:** renal impairment, psoriasis, lupus.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **CYP2D6 substrates** (TCAs, metoprolol, some SSRIs, codeine activation): ↑ levels.
- **Rifampicin:** ↓ levels; **cimetidine:** ↑ levels.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Baseline LFTs before oral treatment.
- Watch for fatigue, anorexia, jaundice, dark urine.
- Monitor CBC in long courses.
- Assess skin/nail improvement (new nail growth).
- Hygiene education.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Toenails take months to grow out normally; finish the 12-week course.
- Report yellow skin, dark urine, persistent nausea or rash.
- Taste changes may occur; tell your doctor.
- Keep feet dry; wear clean socks.

KEY POINTS

- Allylamine — fungicidal for dermatophytes.
- Check LFTs; hepatotoxic.
- Toenails 250 mg daily × 12 weeks.
- Taste disturbance.

SOURCES CHECKED **[234]** Terbinafine 250 mg Tablets (UK SmPC) **[235]** Terbinafine 1 % Cream (UK SmPC) **[236]** Lamisil Tablets 250mg (UK SmPC) **[237]** Terbinafine, oral (US label) **[238]** Terbinafine, oral (US label, Cipla USA Inc)
Full references p. 432–457